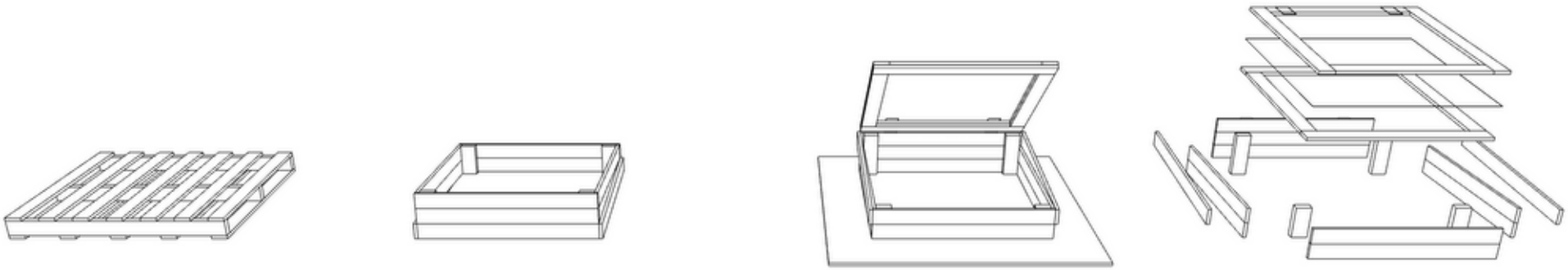
Pallet Cold Frame

Recycled pallet 1x4 deck boards and 2x4 stringers | 40 x 40 in box | lapped 1x4 lid with clear plastic

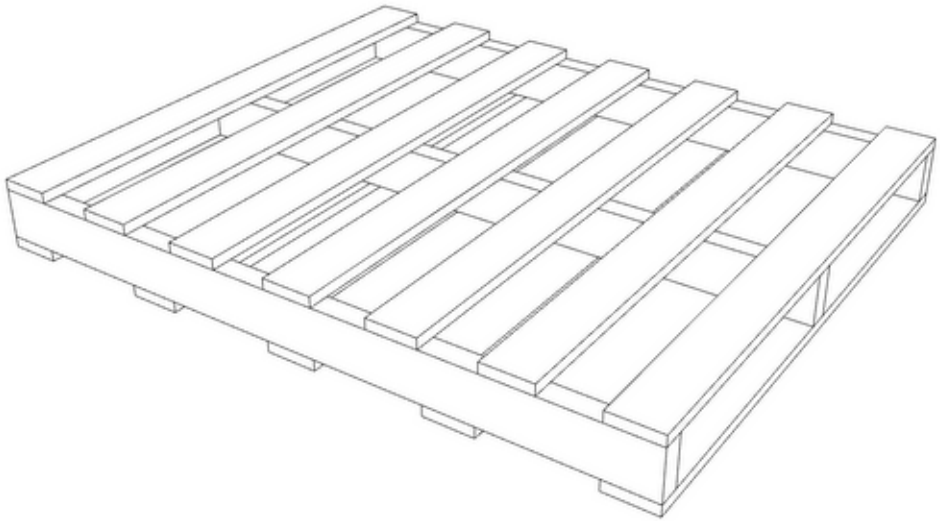


1 Source pallet > 2 Box built upside down > 3 Finished cold frame > 4 Exploded parts

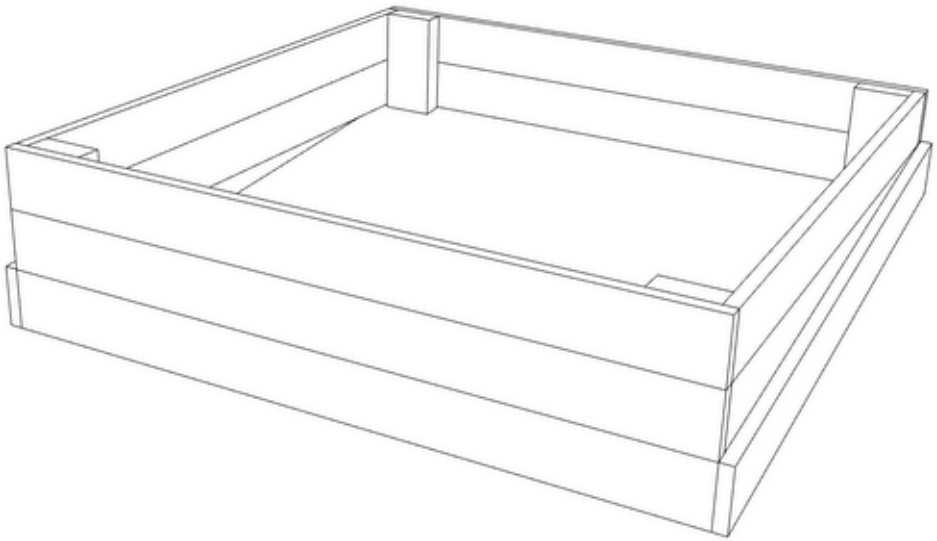
- Box: front 2 boards high (7 in), back 3 boards high (10 1/2 in); sides 2 boards plus one angled board.
- Corner posts cut from a pallet 2x4 stringer; the 1x4s nail into them.
- Built upside down on a flat surface so the top edges are smooth; flipped so the rough ends sit on the soil.
- Lid: two layers of 1x4 with the corners lapped, clamping a sheet of clear plastic between them; hinged at the back.
- Materials: 19 deck boards (about 2 pallets) and one stringer per frame.

Stages 1 and 2: from pallet to box

Take the pallet apart; build the box upside down on a flat surface



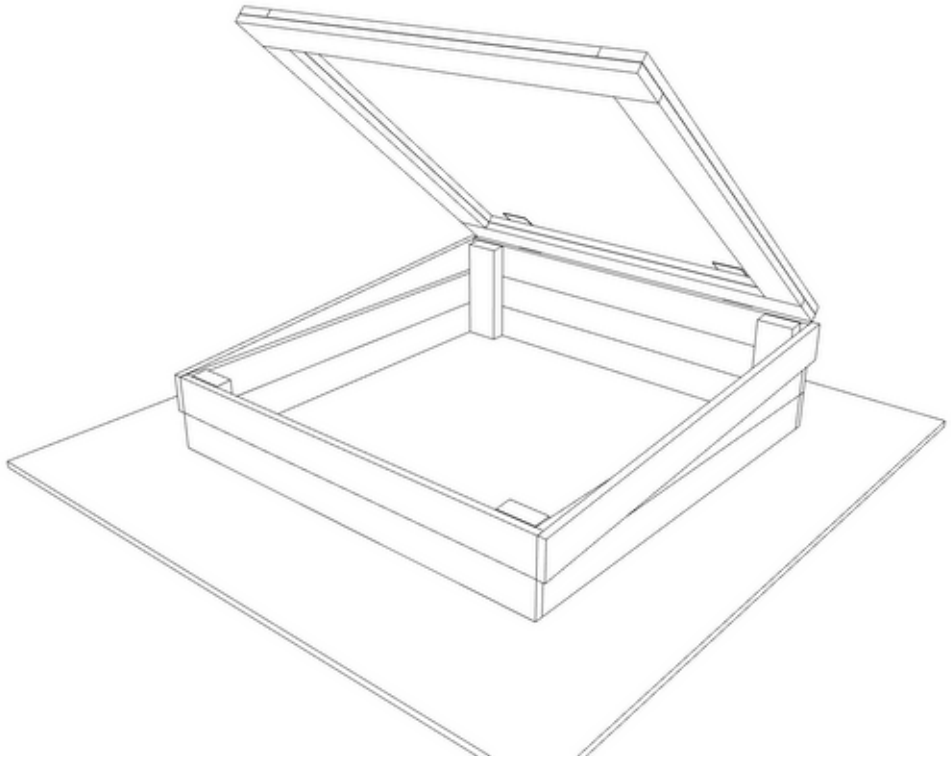
1 Source: one 48 x 40 in pallet
1x4 deck boards (about 40 in) and 2x4 stringers (48 in)



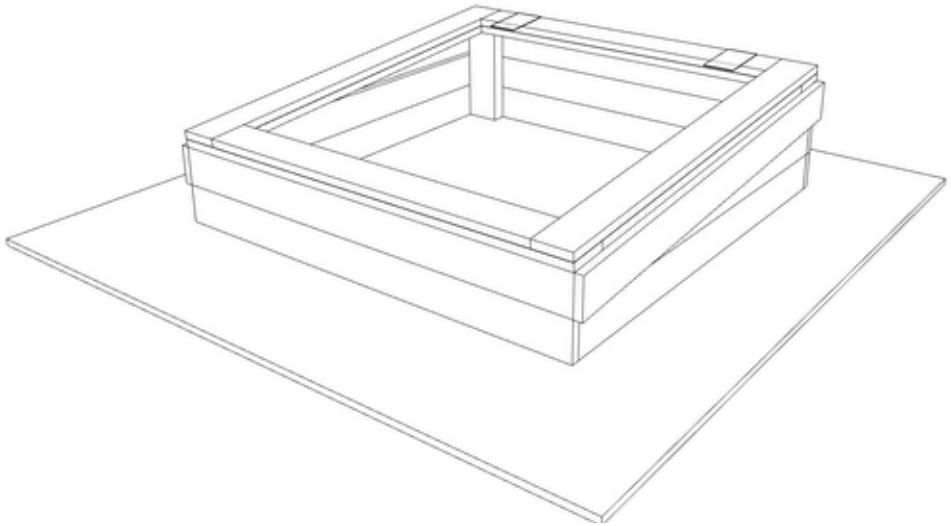
2 Box built upside down
smooth top edges on the bench, posts in the corners

Stage 3: the finished cold frame

Flipped onto the soil; the lid hinges at the high back edge



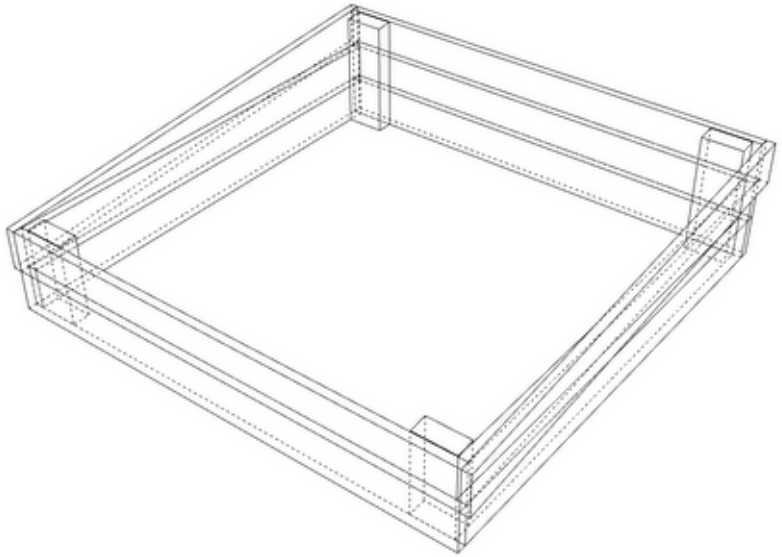
Lid propped open



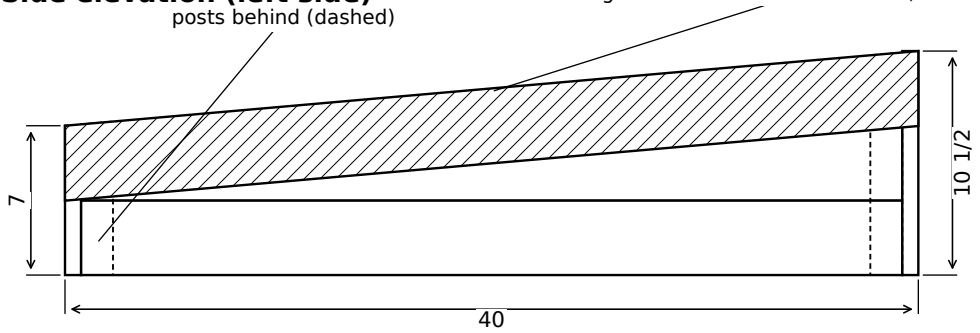
Lid closed

The box

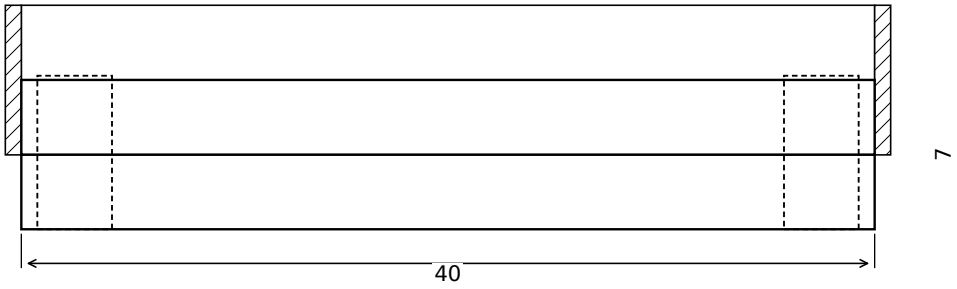
Lid removed; hidden posts shown dashed



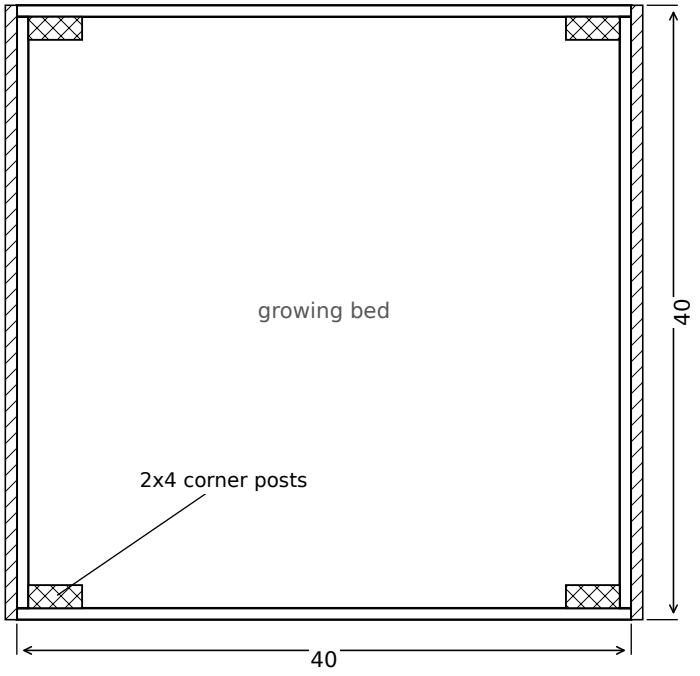
Side elevation (left side)



Front elevation



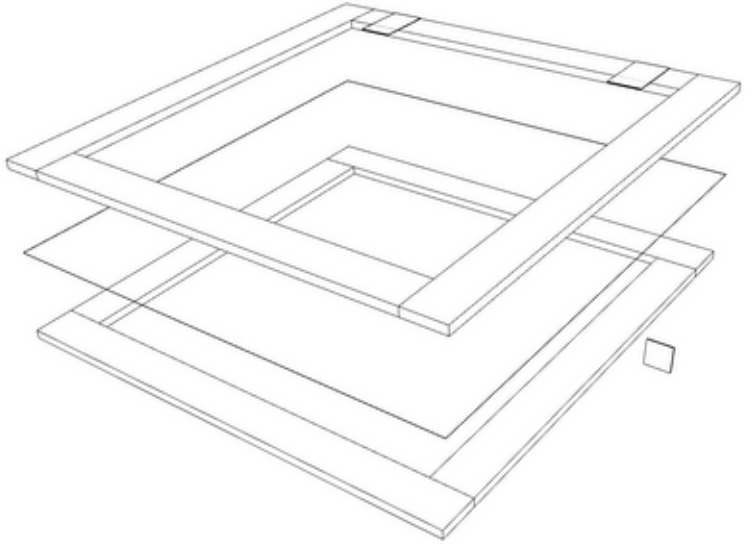
Plan (top view), front at the bottom



Elevations at 1:9, plan at 1:12.5. Boards 3 1/2 x 3/4 in.

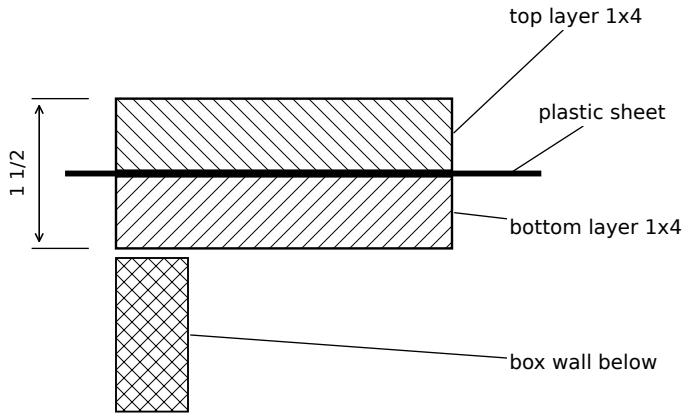
The lid

Two layers of 1x4 with lapped corners clamp a clear plastic sheet between them

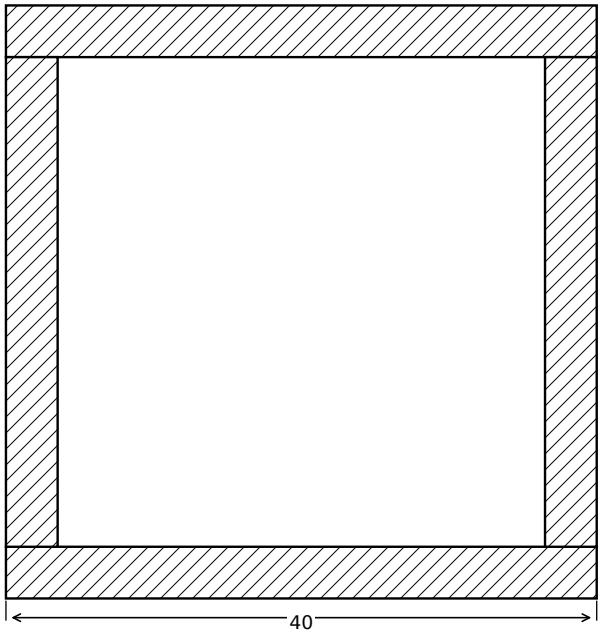


Exploded: top layer, plastic, bottom layer

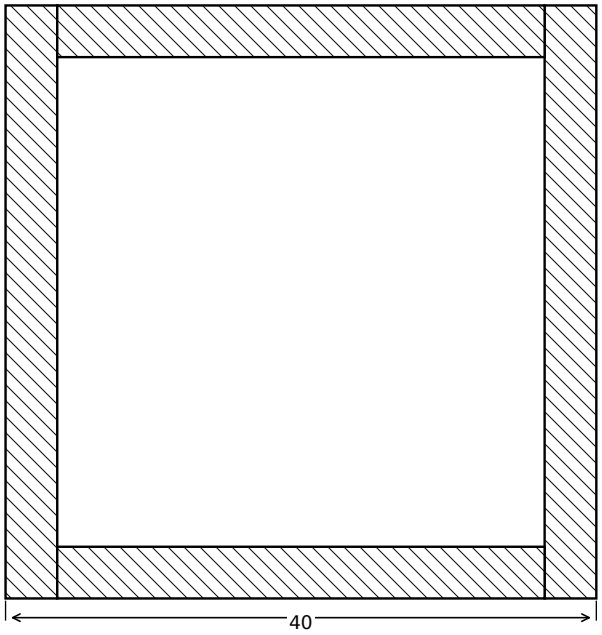
Section through the lid edge (1:2)



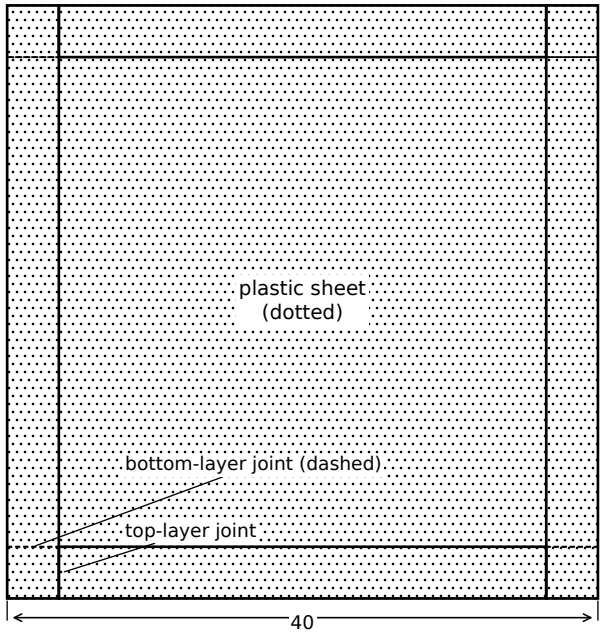
Bottom layer: rails run full width



Top layer: sides run full length



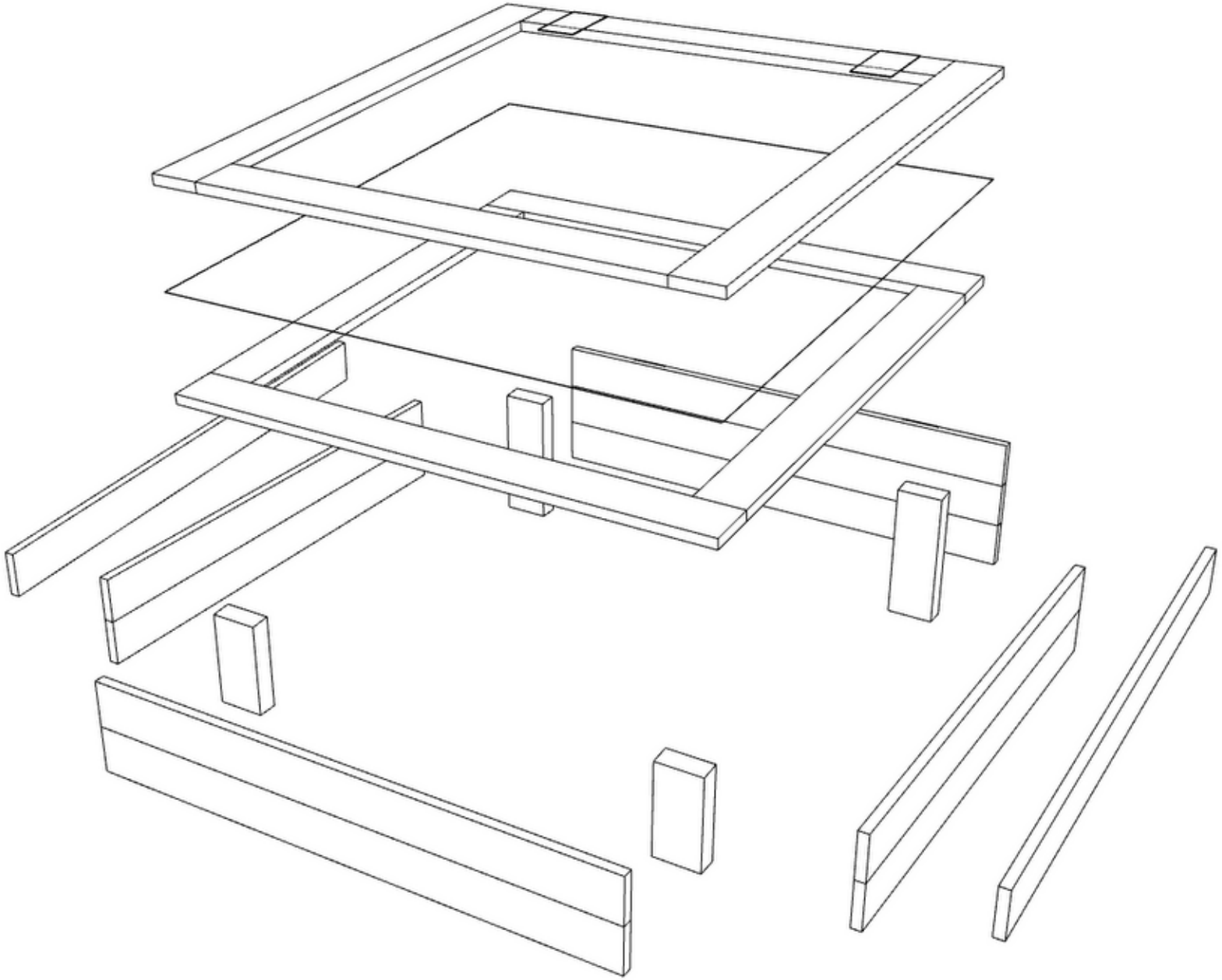
Assembled: joints of the two layers cross



Plans at 1:13. Nail or screw through both layers all round to clamp the plastic.

Every part, exploded

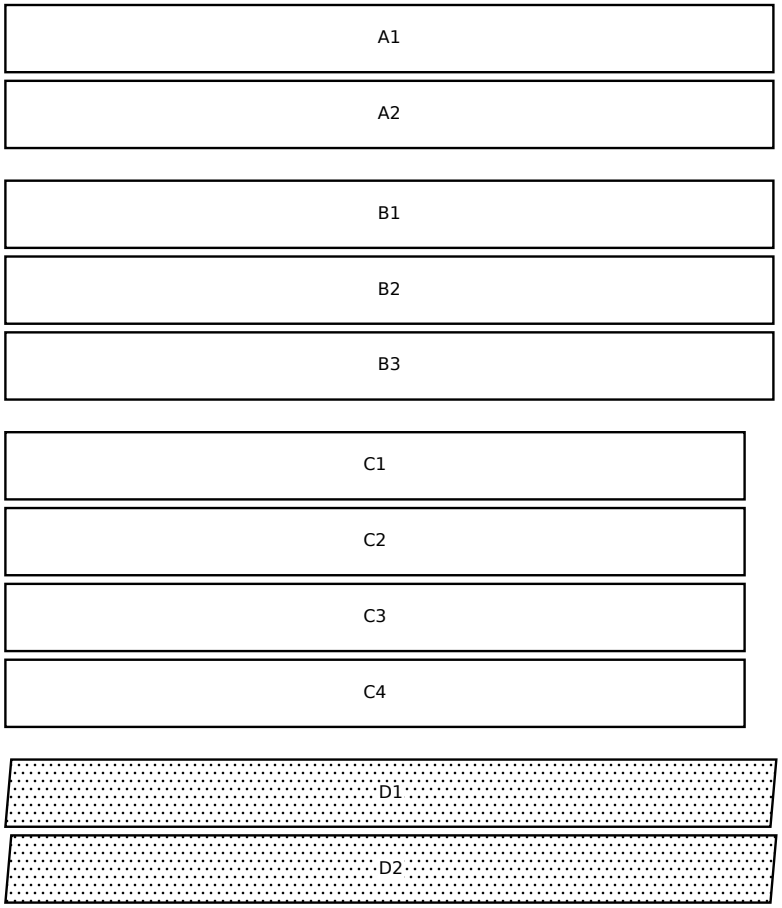
Front and back boards, sides, angled boards, corner posts, and the two lid layers with the plastic



All the pieces, laid out flat (1:10)

One row per piece; letters match the list. 1x4 = 3 1/2 x 3/4 in pallet deck board

BOX (11 boards)



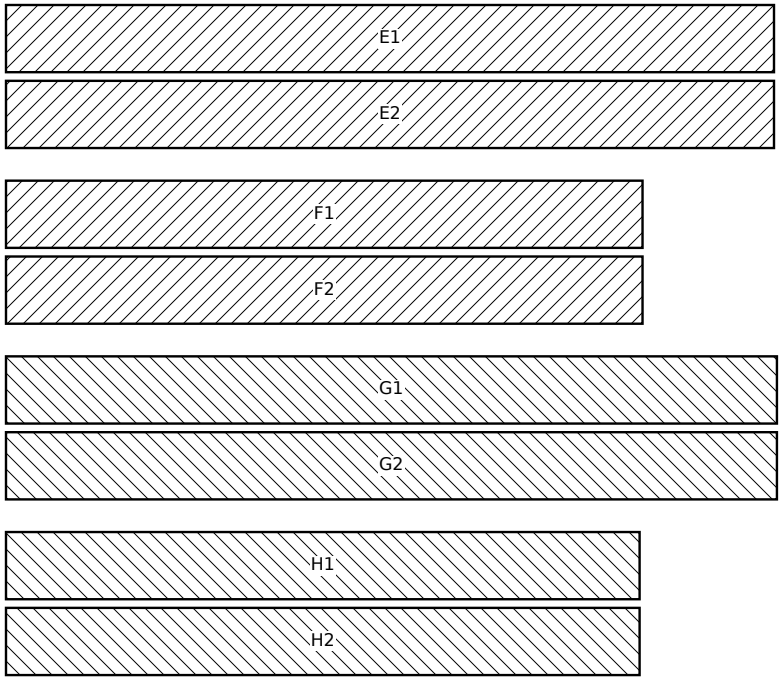
A Front board
2 x 40 in

B Back board
3 x 40 in

C Side board
4 x 38 1/2 in

D Angled side board (ends cut plumb)
2 x 40 1/8 in

LID (8 boards)



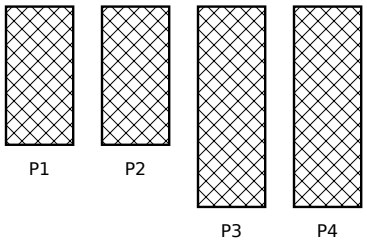
E Bottom layer rail
2 x 40 in

F Bottom layer side
2 x 33 1/8 in

G Top layer side
2 x 40 1/8 in

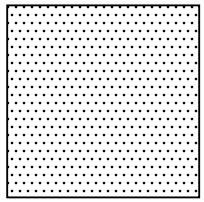
H Top layer rail
2 x 33 in

POSTS (one 2x4 stringer)



P1, P2 front posts, 7 1/4 in
P3, P4 back posts, 10 3/8 in
tops cut to the slope

PLASTIC



S 40 x 40 1/8 in sheet
(drawn at 1:40)

Hatching: lid bottom layer ////, top layer \\\\, angled boards dotted, posts crossed.